Informed Consent for Interview

Dear Participant,

We are student researchers in the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology program at Southwestern University-PHINMA. We are conducting this capstone study:

Architecting a Lightweight Cloud-Based Inventory and Financial Management System: A Mixed-Methods Evaluation of Decision-Making Efficiency in Philippine SMEs

The study examines inventory and financial recordkeeping in Philippine small and medium enterprises and evaluates Kodigo, a cloud-based inventory and financial management system.

What taking part involves

A researcher will ask 11 guided questions about inventory, sales, and reconciliation. The interview is expected to take about 30 to 45 minutes. You may skip questions and should not share passwords, customer records, or confidential business details.

Possible risks and benefits

No direct benefit is promised. Talking about work problems may feel sensitive; you may skip questions or stop. Your experience may help describe SME workflows and assess Kodigo.

Audio recording

We will take written notes. Recording is optional; if you say no, we will use notes only. Your choice does not affect participation.

Recording permission: [ ] I agree to audio recording [ ] I do not agree

Voluntary participation and withdrawal

Participation is voluntary. You may decline, skip questions, or stop without penalty or effect on your business or university relationship. To withdraw, contact us before your notes or transcript are de-identified for combined analysis; afterward, we may not be able to identify your answers.

Privacy and use of information

We will omit your name and business name, use a participant code, and may quote comments without identifying details. The research team and academic adviser alone will access interview notes and transcripts. Signed consent will be stored separately. Audio will be deleted after transcript verification; other records follow university retention requirements.

Researcher contacts

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Agreement
I have read this form or had it explained, and my questions were answered. I understand participation is voluntary, I may stop without penalty, and audio recording is optional. I freely agree to take part.
Participant name (print): _____
Participant signature: _____ Date: _____